Korean variety-show captions as a design language





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What 자막 do



Narrate

What someone is thinking

Joke

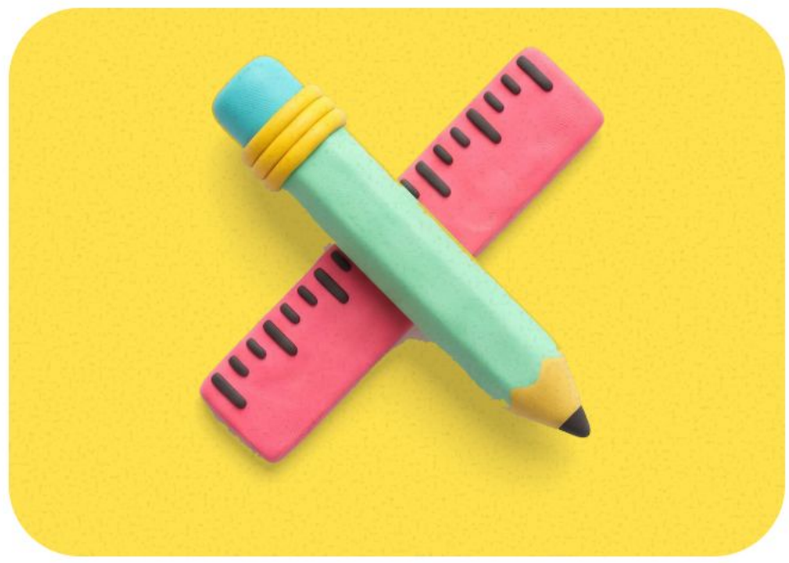
A hidden presenter

Point out

Details viewers might miss

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The visual style



Element	Typical use
Bold rounded type	Friendly and readable
Colour by person	Who’s speaking or feeling
Icons and sound words	Emphasis and humour
Near the speaker	Not only at the bottom

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Pick the moments

Don’t caption everything.

A consistent narrator voice makes it feel human.

✓ Jokes written by a Korean writer

✗ Translated English humour



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In Korea, captions are a second voice.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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